

 LOUISIANA DEPARTMENT OF HEALTH	Division/Section	Family Support
	Chapter No./Name	4 – Economic Independence (EI)
	Part No./Name	P – Strategies to Empower People (STEP) Program
	Section No./Name	P-500-STEP Sanctions/Good Cause
	Document No./Name	P-550-STEP Applying the Sanction
	Effective Date	September 1, 2026

I. STATEMENT OF POLICY

When a work eligible **or non-work eligible** family is determined to be in non-compliance with STEP requirements and does not have good cause, the appropriate STEP sanction **will be** applied.

II. PROCEDURES

When the STEP Coach ***** enters a non-compliance entry in TuaPath**, a task will be generated and routed to the FITAP Worker for processing in LITE.

The FITAP ***** Worker** must enter the appropriate STEP **Non-Compliance Violation Type**, including the correct **Non-Compliance Reason** and **Decision Date** in LITE.

When a STEP sanction is deemed appropriate for an adult parent/caretaker, it is applied to all adult members. In these instances, if a MUP is included in the FITAP certification, the STEP sanction is not applied to the MUP. However, when a STEP sanction is deemed appropriate for a MUP, it is applied to all adult members and the MUP. The STEP Coach must be careful to request a sanction for the correct members.

An Advance Notice of Adverse Action is required prior to **the start of the** STEP sanction and allows the client 13 days to comply prior to case closure. If the client complies during this period, the STEP Coach must manually contact the FITAP ***** Worker** with the date of compliance. **The FITAP Worker will delete the sanction in LITE and run EDBC.** Otherwise, the STEP referral will close automatically at the appropriate time (Refer to [P-610-STEP](#)).

If the STEP sanction is received the month prior or the month of Redetermination the sanction will be entered and processed in LITE at the time of receipt. The action will require a manual Advance Notice of Adverse Action.

The STEP sanction occurrence codes (1, 2, or 3) are tracked **in** LITE by member.

A STEP sanction is considered to have occurred once the Advance Notice of Adverse Action ends. The first month of the sanction period is the first month in which the client does not receive FITAP benefits following case closure. After the Advance Notice of Adverse Action expires and the sanction is actually imposed **in** LITE, the sanction can only be deleted from LITE if it is determined that the client had good cause at the time of non-compliance or if the client wins a subsequent appeal. In these situations, corrective FITAP payments must be made to the client.

If a client who is unwilling to participate voluntarily chooses FITAP case closure prior to a determination of STEP non-compliance, the case closure will not be considered a STEP sanction, unless the request for closure occurs after the Advance Notice of Adverse Action. In these instances, the FITAP ***** Worker** must document the case record to indicate that the client has been made aware that FITAP case closure could also affect eligibility for SNAP and Medicaid benefits.

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APPLYING THE SANCTION FOR MULTIPLE NON-COMPLIANCES

When a client's FITAP case is **within the Advance Notice of Adverse Action period** due to a STEP sanction and a subsequent non-compliance occurs, the STEP Coach must request a sanction for the subsequent non-compliance. If the FITAP case is still active in LITE, the FITAP *** Worker will enter the STEP sanction and send an Advance Notice of Adverse Action for the second non-compliance. If the FITAP case has closed, it is not appropriate to request a subsequent non-compliance.

III. FORMS AND INSTRUCTIONS

There are no forms associated with this policy.

IV. REFERENCES

Code of Federal Regulations, Title 45: [Parts 261, 262, 263, and 265](#)

[TANF Final Rule 2008](#)

[Act 58, 2003 Reg. Session.](#)

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